

SESSION 3

USES — From AI capability to useful application

10:30 AM–12:00 PM •
90 minutes

Where we are in the workshop

A four-step learning journey

1. Fundamentals — what AI is and how it works
2. Thinking about AI — how to reason about capability, limits and consequences
3. Uses — where AI can create practical value
4. Practices — how to work with AI well, safely and deliberately

Learning outcomes

By the end of this session, participants can:

Identify common categories of AI use

Match an AI capability to a real task

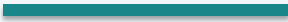
Distinguish augmentation from automation

Spot tasks where AI is a poor fit

Describe one AI use case worth testing

1 — A map of AI uses

Start with capabilities, not apps.



Transition: “We have learned what AI is. Now let’s ask what those capabilities let us do.”

2 min

A practical map of AI uses

Most applications combine a few recurring capabilities

Create — draft, transform, summarize, translate, generate

Explore — brainstorm, compare, explain, ask questions

Analyze — classify, extract, find patterns, interpret data

Act — route, recommend, automate, trigger a workflow

Interact — tutor, coach, simulate, role-play

Think in verbs

**CREATE
EXPLORE
ANALYZE
ACT
INTERACT**

AI is often most useful between steps

Look for the friction in a workflow

Before the task — clarify goals, gather context, generate options

During the task — draft, analyze, simulate, transform, troubleshoot

After the task — critique, summarize, check consistency, prepare next steps

The opportunity is often not “replace the job” but “remove the bottleneck.”

Look for

**BOTTLENECKS
REPETITION
WAITING
COMPLEXITY**

Use case 1 — Writing & communication

AI as a drafting and transformation partner

Generate a first draft from a clear brief

Change tone, length, audience, or format

Turn notes into a structured document

Create alternative headlines, explanations, or examples

Critique clarity, logic, or accessibility

Use case 2 — Learning & teaching

AI can change the learning interaction

- Explain a concept at different levels
- Generate practice questions and scenarios
- Role-play a difficult conversation or interview
- Give feedback against a rubric
- Create examples, counterexamples, and analogies

Use case 3 — Research & sense-making

AI can reduce the cost of navigating information

Turn a broad question into sub-questions

Compare themes across supplied documents

Extract claims, assumptions, and open questions

Build a research plan or interview guide

Summarize — then verify against original sources

Use case 4 — Data & analysis

AI can make analytical work more accessible

Clean or classify information

Describe trends and anomalies in a dataset

Generate formulas, queries, or code

Suggest ways to visualize a problem

Translate analytical output into plain language

Use case 5 — Creativity & ideation

AI expands the option space

- Generate many alternatives quickly
- Combine ideas from different domains
- Challenge an initial concept
- Simulate different audiences or stakeholders
- Move from “give me an answer” to “give me possibilities”

2 — Augmentation or automation?

Two different ways AI changes work.

Transition: “Not every useful AI application should run by itself. The next distinction is about control.”

2 min

Augmentation vs. automation

Choose the level of autonomy deliberately

Augmentation — AI helps a person perform the task better or faster

Automation — AI performs a defined step with limited human intervention

High-stakes, ambiguous, or relationship-heavy work often benefits from augmentation

Stable, repetitive, low-risk steps can be candidates for automation

Many strong workflows combine both

Control matters

**WHO DECIDES?
WHO CHECKS?
WHO ACTS?**

Activity — AI use-case canvas

12 minutes individual or pairs

DO

Choose one real task you do regularly.

Write the goal, inputs, and desired output.

Mark the slowest / hardest step.

Choose: create, explore, analyze, act, or interact.

Decide: augment, automate, or do not use AI.

DEBRIEF

What changed when you described the task as a workflow?

Where would an error matter most?

What would the human still need to own?

What is the smallest experiment you could run?

3 — Choosing good use cases

Value is not the same as novelty.

Transition: “We have generated possibilities. Now we need a filter for deciding what is worth trying.”

2 min

A simple AI opportunity filter

Score the task before you build the workflow

Value — does improving this task matter?

Frequency — does it happen often enough to justify setup?

AI fit — is the task within AI's useful capabilities?

Verifiability — can a person or system check the result?

Risk — what happens if the output is wrong or misused?

Best starting point

**HIGH VALUE
HIGH FIT
LOWER RISK**

What AI is ***not*** automatically good at

Capability ≠ reliability

Knowing what is true without evidence

Understanding unstated context or organizational politics

Making accountable decisions on your behalf

Handling confidential information safely by default

Replacing expertise, judgment, relationships, or responsibility

Close — From possibilities to experiments

Leave with one small, testable next step

Pick one use case with clear value and manageable risk

Define the input and desired output

Keep a human checkpoint

Test on a small sample

Compare AI-assisted work with your normal method

Carry the lesson into Session 4: how to do this well